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Edited by
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# GODS, HEROES, AND MONSTERS

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## About the Cover

The Shield of Achilles—a hypothetical reconstruction by Kathleen Vail

The Shield of Achilles is described in Homer's *Iliad* (18.474–608) and has excited the imagination of artists and scholars since atleast the nineteenth century. Achilles' divine armor was made by Hephaistos himself out of gold, silver, bronze, and tin. Homer uses the fantastic artifact to depict the cosmic and human order: scenes of war and peace, and joy and grief, filled the shield just as they fill these pages. The images, arranged in concentric bands, presumably evoked the detailed low reliefs engraved in metalwork, especially in the so-called "orientalizing" or Daedalic style (8th–7th cents. BCE), which inspires this rendition. The imaginary shield is too dynamic for static artwork to adequately represent. It takes us from the cosmic elements in the central scene (earth and sea, heaven and stars) to the life of human communities in the surrounding rings. In two cities, one at peace and one at war, we see a wedding party, a judgment over a blood crime, men involved in war preparations and battles, and those dedicated to agriculture and its festivities. Sea waves surround the shield's outer rim, as Greeks and Mesopotamians believed the Ocean encircled the inhabited world.

# ANATOLIAN

## 4.2. THE HURRO-HITTITE *SONG OF RELEASE* (DESTRUCTION OF THE CITY OF EBLA)

The Hurro-Hittite *Song of Release* was discovered during excavations in Hattusa in 1983 and 1985. The text was presented in a bilingual format on the tablets, with the Hurrian version in columns i and iv and the Hittite version in columns ii and iii. The sign forms and the language of the Hittite version show that the tablets were inscribed during the Middle Hittite period, the early fourteenth century BCE. Repetitions and parallels among the fragments suggest that there was more than one version or recension. It does not appear to have been a pop-ular text in scribal circles, however, since it was not recopied in later times. The relationship between the Hurrian and Hittite versions remains under debate, namely, whether the Hittite version is simply a translation of the Hurrian and, if so, whether the translation was done by a scribe or the singer mentioned in the explanatory closing lines (colophons) of two of the tablets. Another possibility is that the two versions are the product of an oral poet who could perform in both Hurrian and Hittite.

The discovery of the *Song of Release* was a momentous event for scholars interested in the history of the epic genre in the eastern Mediterranean, providing another important parallel to Greek epics. The story tells of the destruction of the Syrian town of Ebla (Tell Mardikh), overseen by the storm god, because its assembly, against the advice of their king, Meki, refuses to release the people of the town Ikinkalis, who are serving the assembly members. Thus, the plot has similarities to that of the *Iliad*, in which Troy is destroyed because of the failure to return Helen. More specifically, we learn from glancing references to events before the start of the war that the Trojan assembly, swayed by bribes from Paris, had refused to return Helen to a Greek embassy (*Il.* 3.204–224, 11.122–142). Moreover, the opening scenes of the *Iliad*, which create the motivation for Achilles' refusal to fight, retell in a nutshell the same plot, with the request to return a female captive (Chryseis), backed by a god (Apollo). When the request

[7] These were the initial stages in the erection of a building and formed part of temple foundation rituals.

is refused, the god sends a plague on the Achaeans. Likewise, the praise of Zazalla, best speaker in the assembly in the *Song of Release*, matches descriptions of excellent speakers in the *Iliad*, such as Thoas (*Il.* 283–284) and Diomedes (*Il.* 9.54–56). There are also parallels between the *Song of Release* and the Hebrew Bible, specifically Leviticus 25.10 and 26 and Jeremiah 34.

There are still major divergences of opinion on the sequence of events and the overall point of the story. Three sections must belong to the storyline because their colophons state they belong to the *Song of Release*: the proem, which mentions the storm god, the Syrian goddess Ishhara, and a human named Pizikarra; a meeting in the palace of the underworld goddess (Hurrian Allani, the Hittite sun goddess of the earth) with the storm god (Hurrian Teshub, Hittite Tarhun), his brother Suwaliyatt, and the former gods; and the story that takes place in Ebla, involving the storm god, a man named Purra, the Eblaite king Meki, and an important speaker in assembly named Zazalla. Also found with these tablets and parallel fragments were two more tablets and quite a few small fragments containing parables. Many argue that the parables do not belong to the *Song of Release* at all. The parables are included here, however, with further discussion of their possible relationship with the Ebla storyline. The fragments are presented in one possible logical order, which creates one specific overall meaning for the text; but other orders, which would create different messages for the *Song of Release*, are certainly possible.

It is not evident from the text why the storm god is interested in Purra and the other people of Ikinkalis and steps in to demand their release, threatening to visit destruction on Ebla if the assembly does not comply and promising prosperity and victory for the town if they do. A new interpretation is proposed here, namely, that Purra and the other people of Ikinkalis are meant to be serving the cult of the nine dead kings of Ebla and that it is the task of Meki, the tenth king, to ensure his ancestors receive their due, for the prosperity of his kingdom depends on their goodwill and intercession in the underworld. Other solutions have been presented to explain why Purra is described as serving nine kings, with Meki as the tenth: for example, they are regional kings all alive at the same time, or Purra has a supernaturally long life span.

We do not know how this text arrived at Hattusa. Many scholars now accept that it could have been recited in Anatolia as far back as the Old Hittite period, when the first great Hittite king, Hattusili I, was fighting the Hurrians to the south and east of Hatti, ca. 1600 BCE. Indeed, either Hattusili or his grandson (adopted son) Mursili appears to have been responsible for the destruction of Ebla (Tell Mardikh stratum IIIb), although there is no strong reason to assume that this event, as opposed to one of the earlier destructions of the town, is the one mythologized in the song.

SOURCE: Hurro-Hittite *Song of Release*, edition of Neu (1996). Unless otherwise noted, the Hittite version is translated here (CTH 789). All texts come from KBo 32, which stands for Keilschrifttexte aus Bogazköi, one of the two main series that publishes hand copies of the tablets (on the numbering system for Hittite texts, see explanation in Part 3, document 4).

Translated and annotated by M. Bachvarova.



## THE FIRST TABLET

*(The beginning of column i on the obverse is preserved, along with the end of column iv on the reverse [in Hurrian], with the colophon [in Hittite]. The opening appears to mention the principal antagonists, including one human, Pizikarra. The back side presents a conversation between the storm god, Teshub, of the city Kummi, and the Syrian goddess Ishhara, apparently setting the stage for the attack on Ebla.)*

(KBo 32.11 i 1–3) I shall sing of Teshub, p[owerful] lord of Kummi. I shall exalt the young w[oman], the doorbolt of the earth, Alla[ni].

(i 4–6) And along with them I shall tell of the young woman Ishhara, the word-mak[er,] famous for wisdom, goddess.

(i 7–9) I shall tell of Pizikarra . . . E[bla . . . ] who (will) bring [ . . . ] Pizikarra des[troy . . . ] (from?) Nuhashe,[8] and Ebla [ . . . ]

(i 10–13) *(Mostly incomprehensible. Pizikarra, the Ninevan,[9] is mentioned, and the action of binding, along with "to the gods.")*

(i 14–18) *(Incomprehensible except for "to Teshub.")*

(i 19–20) *(Only a few signs visible.)*

*(Column i breaks off before paragraph end. A gap of approximately 50 lines follows. On the reverse, a dialogue between Teshub and Ishhara closes the first tablet. Although little of the beginning of the passage is comprehensible, the pronoun "I" appears, someone is not listening, and the topic is freeing. Ishhara mentions the request of another person, perhaps the request for freedom on the part of the people of Ikinkalis, while Teshub discusses the future destruction of Ebla with her.)*

(iv 12'-15') Ish[hara s]ays words to [Te]shub. S/he asks, ask[s . . . ] . . . Ishhara asks, ask[ . . . ". . . ] I shall give [ . . . ."]

(iv 16'-21') Tesh[ub says] words to Ishhara, "And [n]ow des[troy] Ebla [ . . . ] . . . Ishhara [ . . . ] he will destroy. Who . . . them/it [ . . . ] Ishhara. Ebla . . . them [ . . . ]. And, the countries are destroyed, destroy[ed . . ."]

*(Colophon)*

(iv 22') First tablet of the Song [of] Release o[f . . . ]

## MESSENGER SCENE

*(In the following fragment, in which only the Hittite version is preserved, the storm god, roused from bed by a messenger, talks with his brother Suwaliyat and sends him to Ebla to discuss something with Ishhara. In the* Kumarbi Cycle, *messengers are typically sent to demand that a god make a visit to the messenger's master to discuss a problem, so it is likely that a similar situation occurs here. It has been proposed that this fragment belongs in column iv of the first tablet. It is part of the action that leads to Teshub and Ishhara's meeting in which they have the conversation preserved in column iv of KBo 32.11.)*

(KBo 32.37 4'-7') [ . . . ] in the night [ . . . . E]arly in the morning [ . . . ] message rep[ort- . . . Tarh]un aro[se] from his bed [ . . . ]

[8] Nuhashe was an area in north Syria.

[9] Nineveh was the home city of the Hurrian goddess Shawushka, who was syncretized with Ishtar.

(8'-11') [sw]iftly he crossed [ . . . ] And Tarhun [ . . . ] release (obj.) [ . . . ". . . l]et go!" And, Tarhun [began] t[o] speak [words] t[o Suwal]iyat.

(12'-19') "[ . . . ] loyal Suwaliyat, hold [your ear c]ocked! Swiftly go to the city of the throne,[10] and go [to the house] of Ishhara. You go and stress these wo[rds in] front of [Ishhara . . . ] I, far away, you be[fore . . . ] you . . . I [will] bring [ . . . ]. Call [ . . . ] to you!"

## ALLANI'S FEAST IN THE UNDERWORLD

*(The meeting between the storm god and the sun goddess of the earth [Hurr. Allani] in her underworld palace may come next, again following the trajectory found in other Hurro-Hittite narrative songs, in which one meeting leads to another meeting to continue the discussion of a problem. According to my interpretation, the storm god goes to the underworld to discuss the problem of the captivity of the people of Ikinkalis because the underworld gods are interested in the fate of the dead kings whom the people of Ikinkalis should be caring for. Indeed, Ishhara, who is connected to the former gods, that is, the earlier generation of gods, could have been the one to suggest the meeting. This tablet preserves most of the obverse but only fragments of the reverse.)*

(KBo 32.13 ii 1–8) When Tarhun went, he went inside the palace of the Sun Goddess of the Earth. His throne [was X]. When Tarhun the king went in from outside, Tarhun sat aloft on a throne the size of a field of an IKU,[11] and he raised his feet on a stool of the size of a field of seven *tawalla*s.

(ii 9–14) Tarhun and Suwaliyat went under the dark earth. The Sun Goddess of the Earth girded herself up. She turned before Tarhun. She made a fine feast, the doorbolt of the earth, the Sun Goddess of the Earth.

(ii 15–20) She slaughtered 10,000 oxen before great Tarhun. She slaughtered 10,000 oxen. She slaughtered 30,000 fatty-tailed sheep, and there was no counting for those kids, lambs, and billy goats, she slaughtered so many.

(ii 21–27) The bakers prepared (food) and the cup-bearers came in, [wh]ile the cooks set forth the breast meat. They brought them (the pieces) with bowls [ . . . ]. The time of eating arrived, and Tarhun sat to eat, while she seated the Former Gods to Tarhun's right.

(ii 28–34) The Sun Goddess of the Earth before Tarhun stepped like a cup-bearer. The fingers of her hand are long, and her four fingers lie below the cup, and the drinking-vessels with which [she gives] to drink, inside them lies goodness.

*(The column breaks off before paragraph end. The back side of the tablet is very damaged. We can pick out "they [d]ivide (the food?)," "when it was di[vid]ed," and "in front of Tarhun s/he stood [u]p." The next paragraph opens with the name of the storm god, then a second singular verb form shows the passage is in direct speech, probably produced by Tarhun, then the sun goddess of the earth appears as the subject and, "b[owing, began] t[• s]peak." The colophon is partially preserved, showing that the song is attributed to a singer: "[ . . . ] Release [ . . . ] sing[er] not finished.")*

[10] Ebla.

[11] One IKU = 15 meters, but its value as a measurement of area is unknown.



## EVENTS IN EBLA

According to the interpretation offered here, a discussion among the gods about the plight of the deceased kings of Ebla, who are not receiving the veneration that is their due, leads to the decision to threaten the Eblaite assembly with the destruction of their city. However, it is unknown how the storm god first made contact with the Eblaite king Meki. Perhaps a negative omen or other sign incites Meki to find out the state of mind of the storm god. Or perhaps Purra receives a sign and approaches Meki, leading to a meeting between the three of them. According to my interpretation, the storm god first speaks directly to the king, then the king goes to the assembly to convey his threats, repeating them word for word. Meki, as the representative of the storm god, is comparable to the Hebrew Bible prophets who utter the word of God but are often ignored. He bears a name that is known to have designated a nineteenth-century BCE ruler of Ebla (cf. West Semitic *mlk*, "king," as in Ugaritic *milku*, Hebrew *melekh*).

This section of the *Song of Release* begins in the middle of the conditional threats of the storm god. KBo 32.20 contains some of the beginning of the god's demand, but unfortunately only the Hurrian side is preserved, leaving the highly repetitious passage nearly incomprehensible. From the scattered words and phrases we can discern in the passage, we know that the god mentions a set of kings, whose names are Hurrian, two of them compounds with "Ebla": Aribibla, "who gave Ebla," and Paibibla, "who built Ebla" (which means they must be kings of Ebla and not regional kings outside Ebla, as some scholars have postulated). In column i on the obverse we can pick out, for example, "for eighteen/eighty years," "they brought as king Paibibla to the throne," and "in the eighteenth/eightieth year," and then the next king is introduced, so it seems that we are hearing about a series of kings' reigns, with comments on Purra interspersed. I suggest that Purra and the others care for the ancestor cult of the dead kings, a duty that would include remembering their names and some facts about each of their reigns. In between, we learn about something "of Purra," "with a gift," "loosing" (a verb), and Teshub, "lord of Kummi," as an agent in the sentence. In column iv on the reverse side, there is mention of "giving to a lord" and of a "female slave," and we learn that "Teshub knows."

Then we segue into the following passage translated from KBo 32.19, with KBo 32.22 used to fill in some *lacunae*. Somehow Purra and other servants are involved with a series of kings of Ebla, and the storm god has taken notice of the situation.

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(KBo 32.19 ii 1–4) "Re[lease in goodwill] the sons of the city Ikinkal, and release [especial]ly [Purra], the o[ne] to be given back, who [give]s to eat [to the nine kin]gs.

(ii 5–10) "[And,] Ikin[kalis in the city of the throne gav]e [to eat] to three kings. B[ut], (in) Ebla, [in the city of the throne he] ga[ve] to eat [t]o six kings. But, now he, T[arhun, gets] u[p] before [y]ou, [Mek]i.[12]

[12] The Hurrian version specifies that Meki is the tenth king (i 9–10).

(ii 11–15) "If [you (pl.) make] re[lease] in Ebla, [the city of the throne,] if you [make] r[elease, I will] exalt your weapons like [X].

(ii 16–19) "Your [weapons] alone will begin [t]o [defeat] the enem[y], [while] your plowed fiel[ds will go and thrive for you] in prai[se.]

(ii 20–23) "Bu[t] if y[ou] don't [ma]ke release in [Eb]la, in the city of the throne, then (when it is) the seventh da[y], I will come to you, yo[urse]lves.

(ii 24–26) "I will destroy the ci[ty] of Ebla. As if it had n[ever] been settled, so I will make it!

(ii 27–31) "I will smash the [lower] walls of the city of Ebla like a c[up]. And, I will trample the upper wall [li]ke a clay pit!"

*(The tablet becomes too fragmentary for continuous translation, but discernable is "[bef]ore (him) he speaks" (ii 45), marking the end of the speech. Although the speaker of these words is not mentioned in the remains of the tablet, it can be surmised that it is Tarhun arguing on behalf of Purra, who seems to be the leader of the people of Ikinkalis, as Purra stands before Meki, the tenth king of Ebla.*

*We next pick up the action in Ebla in KBo 32.16, of which only the Hittite side is decipherable. Zazalla, a particularly renowned speaker in assembly, who bears a name known from the third-millennium archives at Ebla, is introduced responding antagonistically to the king.)*

(KBo 32.16 ii 1–5, KBo 32.59 1'–4') [ . . . there is no one] who speaks against him [ . . . ] among the elders, there is no one who speaks against him. [There is no]one who makes a response to him. [No] on[e] talks.

(KBo 32.16 ii 6–10, KBo 32.54 6'–10') But [i]f there is one who speaks greatly in [the ci]ty, [whose wo]rds no one turns aside, Zazalla is the one who speaks greatly. In the place of assembly, his words [n]o one overcomes.

(KBo 32.16 ii 11–13) [Zazal]la began [t]o speak to Meki, "Why [do you] speak obeisance, star of Ebla, Me[ki . . . ]?"

*(The rest of KBo 32.16 is very damaged, but KBo 32.15 runs parallel to KBo 32.16 ii 17–iii 18', which is used here to fill in the* lacunae *of KBo 32.15. Here Zazalla [or another member of the anti-release party] rebuts the words of Meki, arguing that if Tarhun were in want, each would contribute whatever he might need; if someone were depriving the god, the Eblaites would mitigate the god's suffering. He acknowledges that even a god can suffer like a human. But under no circumstances will he agree to releasing the people of Ikinkalis. The king then speaks in front of the storm god again, the deity possibly represented as a baetyl.)*

(KBo 32.15 ii 4'–6a') "[If Tar]hun is injured by oppression and he [a]sks [for release], if Tarhun is [o]ppressed, each will g[i]ve Tarhun [one shekel of sil]ver.

(ii 7'–9') "[Ea]ch will give half a shekel [of gold], [w]e [will each give] him [one shekel] of silver. But, if he, Tarhun, is hungry, we will each give one measure of barley [to the g]od.

(ii 10'–13') "[Ea]ch will pour a half measure of wheat, [a]nd each will pour for him one measure of barley. But if [Tarhun] is naked, we will each clothe him with a fine garment. The god is (like) a person.

(ii 14'–17') "But, if he, Tarhun, is cursed, each of us will give him one *kupi*-vessel of fine oil, we will (each) pour out for him fuel, and we will free him from deprivation. The god is (like) a person.



(ii 18'–21') "We will rescue him, Tarhun the oppressed. He who harms him, we will not make him a release. Does your mind rejoice inside you, Meki?

(ii 22'–25') "First of all, your heart will not rejoice inside you, Meki, while, secondly, inside Purra, who is to be given back, his mind will rejoice.

(ii 26'–29') "In the case we let those ones go, who will give to us t[o] eat? They are cupbearers for us, and they give out to us. They are cooks for us, and they wash for us.

(iii 1–4) "And, the thread which they spin is [thick] like the hair [of an ox.] But, if for you releasing [is desirable,] re[lease] your male and female servants!

(iii 5–7) "Surrender your son! Send [ . . . your] wife! With u[s . . . ] on the throne in the city, Me[ki . . . ]"

(iii 8–11) When Mek[i] he[ard] the word, he b[eg]an to wail. [He] wai[ls . . . ], Meki. He [di]d obeisance a[t] the feet of [T]arhun.

(iii 12–14) Meki, bowing to Tarhun, spoke the words, "[L]isten to me, Tarhun, great ki[n]g of Kummi,

(iii 15–20) "I will g[i]ve it, (i.e.,) compensation, but my [c]ity will not give i[t]. Nor will Zazalla, son of Pazz[anik]arri give, relea[se]." Meki (tried to?) purify his ci[ty] from sin, the [ci]ty of Eb[la]. He (tried to?) throw aside the sins for the sake of his city.

(iii 21–24) [ . . . ] Because the great king of Kummi [ . . . ] the great king of Kummi, [ . . . ]. Before the stone [ . . . ]

(iii 25'–26') *(Only a few signs remain.)*

*(Colophon)*

(left edge) Fifth tablet of Release, no[t finished.]

*(Another fragment seems to fit into the narrative around this point or a bit later in the action on the human plane. It begins with a direct speech, which could be either by a human or a god, but it is likely that the speaker is human because he appears to be on a different plane from the sun god, the all-seeing shepherd and administrator of justice, who [looks?] down from the sky.)*

(KBo 32.10 ii 1–3) [". . . the lan]d of Lulluwa[13] [ . . . let] not good, let not [ . . . ] let him/it not find [X]."

(ii 4–6) [ . . . ] shepherd of all [ . . . ] from the sky Istanu [ . . . ] began [to do X].

(ii 7–10) [ . . . ] the great king of [Kumm]i [ . . . ] slay[ . . . the land of L]ulluwa [ . . . ] not [ . . . ]

*(The obverse breaks off before paragraph end.)*

(iii 2'–7') [ . . . ] Piz[ikarra . . . ] in pr[ison . . . ] bound to the stone. God [X] of Kummi, god [Y] has bound the destruction of Purra to the basalt stone.

*(It appears, then, that Purra lost his life in the course of the story. I suggest the stone mentioned here is a baetyl of the storm god. Pizikarra also appears in another fragment in which destroying in the third person is mentioned: "Pizi- . . . / he destroyed . . . / he injured . . ." (KBo 32.32 right col. 3'–5'). Pizikarra seems to be the human agent of the city's destruction.)*

[13] Lullu(wa) is a semimythical land to the north of Mesopotamia.

## The Parables

Two tablets (KBo 32.12 and KBo 32.14), each containing a series of parables, were found spilled out of the same large jar that contained the fragments of the *Song of Release*. How the parables could fit into the *Song of Release* and even whether they belong to that narrative has been a matter of dispute. Both preserve the end of the tablet, where a colophon could be inscribed, but only one of them (KBo 32.12) contains a mostly lost colophon. It is possible to reconstruct it as follows: "second tablet (of the Song) [o]f R[elease], not finished," although this has been disputed. However, this tablet cannot follow directly on KBo 32.11. Those who wish to include the parables in the *Song of Release* must assume KBo 32.11 and 12 each belong to different versions of the text. Others prefer to simply exclude the parables from the narrative altogether. It is true that if an entire tablet of parables were included in the narrative, it would be a major digression in the action.

There is no clear place for the parables in the preserved narrative, nor are we told who is telling these tales, which are described as "wisdom" (Hurr. *madi*, Hitt. *hattatar*). I suggest that Ishhara, described as "the word-mak[er,] famous for wisdom" in the proem, is the speaker and that she tells the tales to illustrate the consequences of the behavior of the Eblaite assembly, who fail to obey their king and the storm god. Besides the general thematic parallels between the parables' message and the point of the *Song of Release*, there is one specific link, the fate of the insubordinate cup, which is smashed by the storm god in KBo 32.14, just as the god threatens to smash Ebla like a cup (KBo 32.19 ii 27–31); these passages have parallels with Isaiah 29.16, 45.9 and Jeremiah 18.6. A cup is the protagonist in the last parable of KBo 32.12 as well, but the story (fragmentary and in Hurrian) is different from that in KBo 32.14.

Only one tablet (KBo 32.14), which is well preserved, is translated here. For reasons having to do with the layout of the text in the tablet and the lack of a colophon, it has been considered to be a draft, rather than a final copy. The final parable, concerning a woodpile, which represents an ungrateful apprentice, is very fragmentary, so a composite of the Hurrian and Hittite versions is presented here, with words of unknown meaning represented by question marks.

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(KBo 32.14 ii 1–16) A mountain expelled a deer fro[m its] own body. The deer we[nt] forth to another mountain, and he got fat. He became rebellious, and he began to curse the mountain in return, "On which mountain I graze, if only fire would burn it up, and Tarhun would strike it! If only fire would burn it up!" And, when the mountain heard, his heart was sickened inside him, and the mountain cursed the deer in return, "The deer whom I fattened, now he curses me in return. Let the hunters also bring him, the deer, down, and let the bird catchers take him! His fat let the hunters take, and his hide let the bird catchers take!"

(ii 17–21) But, it is not a deer. That one is a man, a man who ran away from his city and arrived at another land. When he became rebellious, he began to plot evil in return against the city, so the gods of the city have cursed him.

(ii 23–25) Leave aside that word; I will tell you another word. List[e]n to the message, and I will tell you wisdom.



(ii 26–30) There was a deer—the meadows which were on the side of a river, those ones he grazes, but which meadows are on the far side, he keeps placing his e[yes] on those also. He did not arrive at the meadows on (that) side, nor did he reach anything.

(ii 31–38) But, it is not a deer. That one is a man, a man whom his lord makes a borderland commander. They made him borderland commander in one district, but he keeps placing his eyes on a second district. The gods impressed upon that man wisdom, so he did not arrive at that district, nor did he reach a second district.

(ii 39–41) Leave aside that word; I will tell you another word. Listen to the message, and I will tell you wisdom.

(ii 42–51) A smith cast a cup for glory; he cast it and stood it up. He set it with ornamentation. He engraved it. He made it shine with brilliance. But, the one who cast it, him the foolish copper beg[an] to curse in return, "If only he who cast me, his han[d] would break off, and his right tendon would wither away!" When the smith heard, his heart was sickened inside him.

(ii 52–60) The smith began to speak before his heart, "Why does the copper which I poured curse me in return?" The smith said a curse against the cup, "Let Tarhun also strike it, the cup, him wrench off its ornaments. Let the cup fall into the canal, and let the ornaments fall into the river."

(iii 1–5) It is not a cup. That one is a man, a son who is an enemy before his father. He grew up, and he reached maturity, and he was no longer paying attention to his father, (he is one) whom the gods of his father have cursed.

(iii 6–8) Leave aside that word; I will tell you another word. Listen to the message, and I will tell you wisdom.

(iii 9–12) A dog pulled out a *kugulla*-bread from an oven. He dragged it forth from the oven, and he drenched it in oil. He drenched it in oil, and he sat down, and he began to eat it.

(iii 13–19) It is not a dog. He is a man whom his lord makes district commander. He increased the collecting of taxes in that city afterwards, and he became very rebellious, and he was no longer paying attention to the city. They were able to report him before his lord, and the taxes that he had swallowed he began to pour out before his lord.

(iii 20–22) Leave aside that word; I will tell you another word. Listen to the message, and I will tell you wisdom.

(rev. 28–32) [A p]ig(?) pulls forth a *kugulla*-bread from an oven. He dragged [it] forth from the oven, and he drenched [it] in oil. He drenched it in oil, and he sat down, and he began to eat it. It is [not a p]ig (?). He is a man whom his lord makes the commander of a land. He increased the collecting of taxes in that [city] afterwards, and he became very rebellious, and he was no longer [paying attention] to the city. They were able to report him before his lord, and the taxes that he had swallowed he began to pour out before his lord.

(rev. 34) Leave [as]ide that word; I will tell you another w[or]d. Listen to the message, and I will tell [yo]u wisdom.

(rev. 41–47) [A craftsman] built a tower for glory. Its excavation trenches reached down to the Sun Goddess of the Earth, and [its bat]tle[ments] reached up close to

heaven. But, the one who built it, him the fooli[sh wall] began to curse in return, "He who built me, if only his hand would bre[a]k off, [a]nd his [right] tendon would wither away!" The craftsman heard, and his heart f[elt] bad inside him. [The craftsman] says before his mind, "Why does the tower which I built curse me?" The craftsman spoke a curse [against the tower], "Let Tarhun also strike it, the tower, let him pull up its foundations. Let [X] fall down into the canal, and let the brickwork fall down into the river."

(rev. 50–52) [It is not] a tower. That one is a man, a son who is an enemy before his father. He grew up, and [he] reached to (the age of) [s]ense, and he was no longer paying attention to his father, and the gods of his father [. . .] have cursed him.

(rev. 54) [L]eave [aside] that [w]ord; I will tell you another word. Listen to the message, and I will tell you wisdom.

(rev. 55–65, lower edge 66–71, left edge 1–7) *(Hurrian version:)* [W]ood [. . .] a saw [. . .] the one who places (it) [. . .] so that [. . .] struck (it) repeatedly, so that a donkey transported (it). The [r]aiser stacked the woodpile near a canal. (Its) base?-ed the [ea]rth below; (its) ? ?-ed them (to) heave[n] above. The [fo]olish wood cursed the one who erected (it), "If only I could brea[k] the hand of the one who stacked me, and I could [paral]yze his right hand within." The raiser, hearing, w[as] sickened on his inside. The raiser said, he spoke to his [i]nside, "Why does the wood which was raised by me keep cursing me?" The raise[r] said a [curs]e against the wood. *(Combining the Hittite and Hurrian versions:)* "Let [Tarhun] also strike it, [the wood . . . ]. Let the roots (?) fall into the canal, and [let] the leaves [be] scattered into the water. It is not wood, it is a man. He is an apprentice (?). He ?-ed. He grew up, and he reached to (the age of) sense, and he ?-es his master. [ . . . ]. He will die in [ . . . ]. Lik[e] a dog [ . . . ] under a [ch]air he will die [ . . . ].